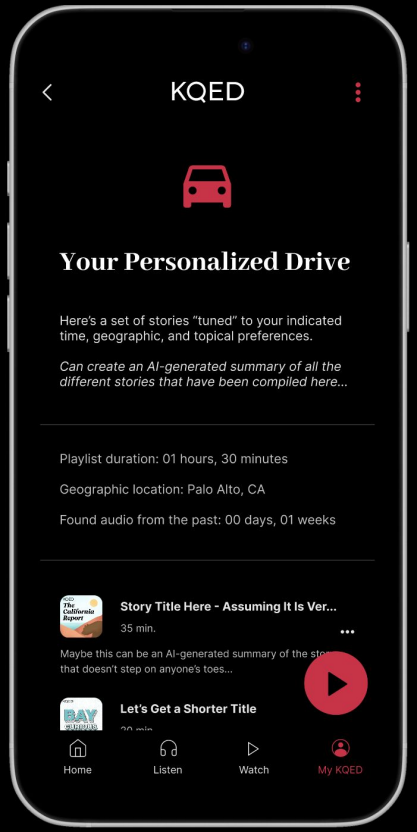
EXPLORING COMPUTATIONAL JOURNALISM
WEEK 7, PHASE 2.0 DEMO

tuesday, 02.17.26

frontseat baby

drive your listening experiences

JOSH B., ELLA J., ANANYA N., JAMES V.



THE **REAL** FRONTSEAT BABIES

KQED

josh *b.*

ella *j.*

ananya *n.*

james *v.*

just a *few* updates...

phase 1.0

How do we get national, regional, *and* local news to an audience seamlessly and personalize their individual experiences to optimize retention?

→ *combine KQED and Embarcadero Media archives*

→ *make everything audio*

→ *bundle the news*

phase 2.0

Can we use of *all* of the unsaved content in KQED's 24 hour live stream to give audiences more control over their listening experience?

→ testing user interest in personalization and control.

→ improving story segmentation when pulling clips from the live stream

→ trying out those story segments in a remixed feed

what are our users saying?

“

The ideal experience for me would [be] to select which stories to *listen to in depth (i.e. full length)*, which ones I could *digest more in synopsis form*, and which ones I *choose to skip on a particular day*.

the survey

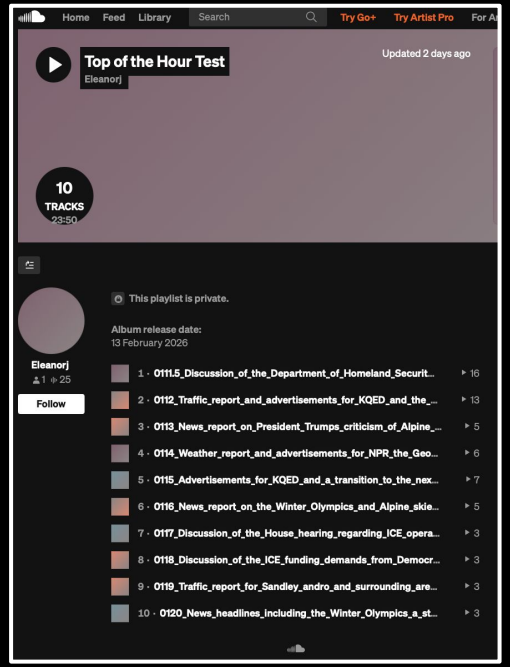
11 participants filled out our survey (thank you **RB** and **Serdar**)!

Some things we asked:

- Is a “skippable” version of the live stream appealing?
- Does customization by topic, geography, time, etc. seem interesting?

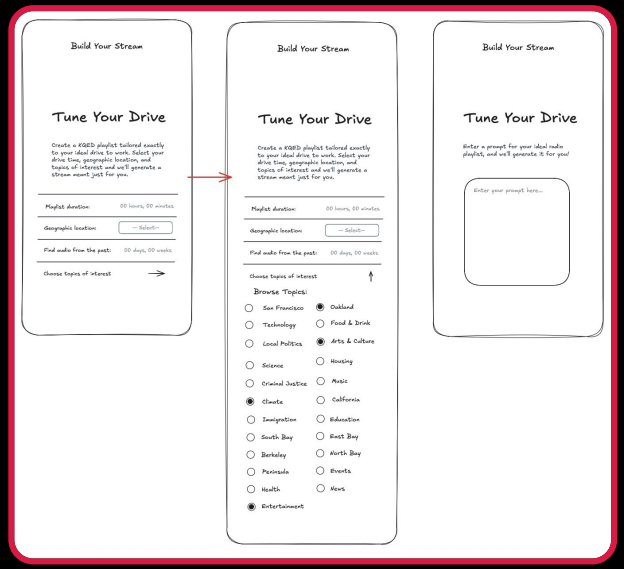
What we got back:

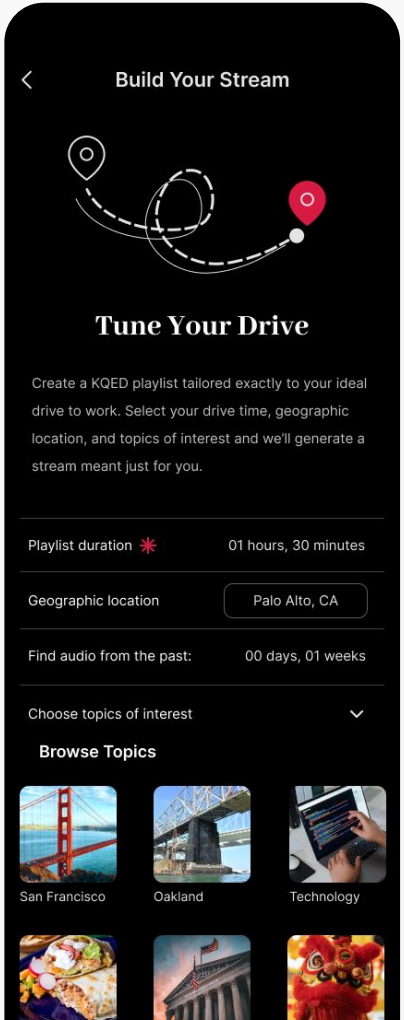
- 81% of participants **like** the idea of a **“skippable” live stream**
- 91% of participants said they would be **interested** in one or more **customization/personalization options**

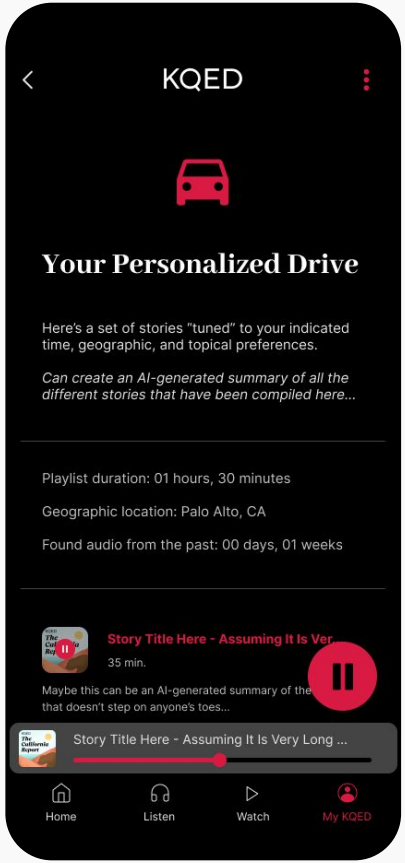


A balance between allowing the user to personalize their listening experience
AND
including content that creates (subconscious) avenues for exploration and variety will be a key element to a successful outcome here.

a new product goal







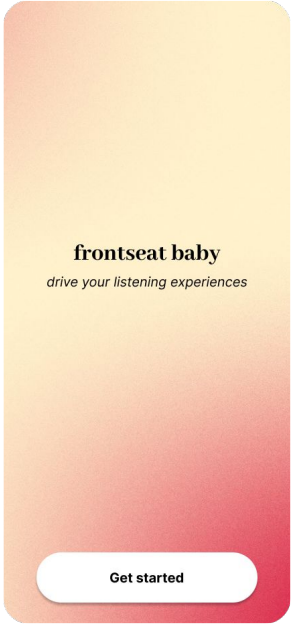
Take KQED's existing categories to form a playlist feature with customization options

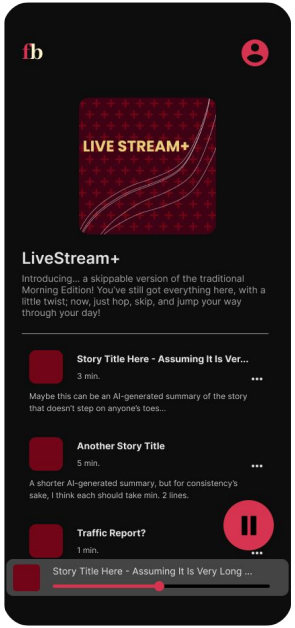
more recent updates (since last week)

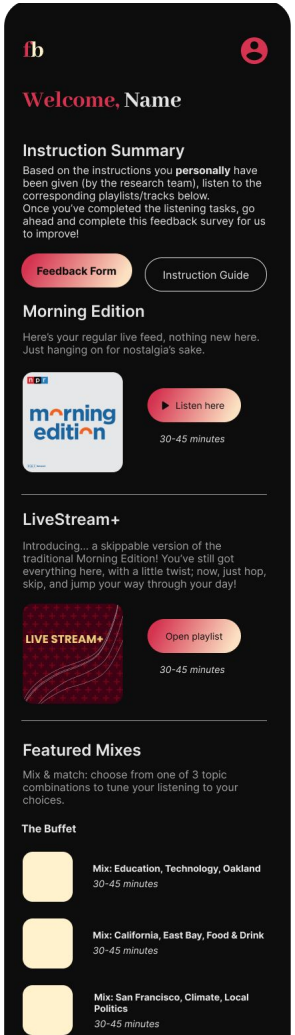
Moving into production phases with Figma's help…

Users will be able to select their "playlists" based on the instructions given for their particular version of the study.

Lots of opportunities for granular qualitative **and** quantitative data collection here!







projected users + experiences

Busy Parent Serdar

→ builds a playlist based on topics he needs to catch-up on

→ uses voice command to skip boring stuff

→ can find and share his favorite clips with friends

Roadbiker RB

→ builds a playlist without any of those silly traffic reports

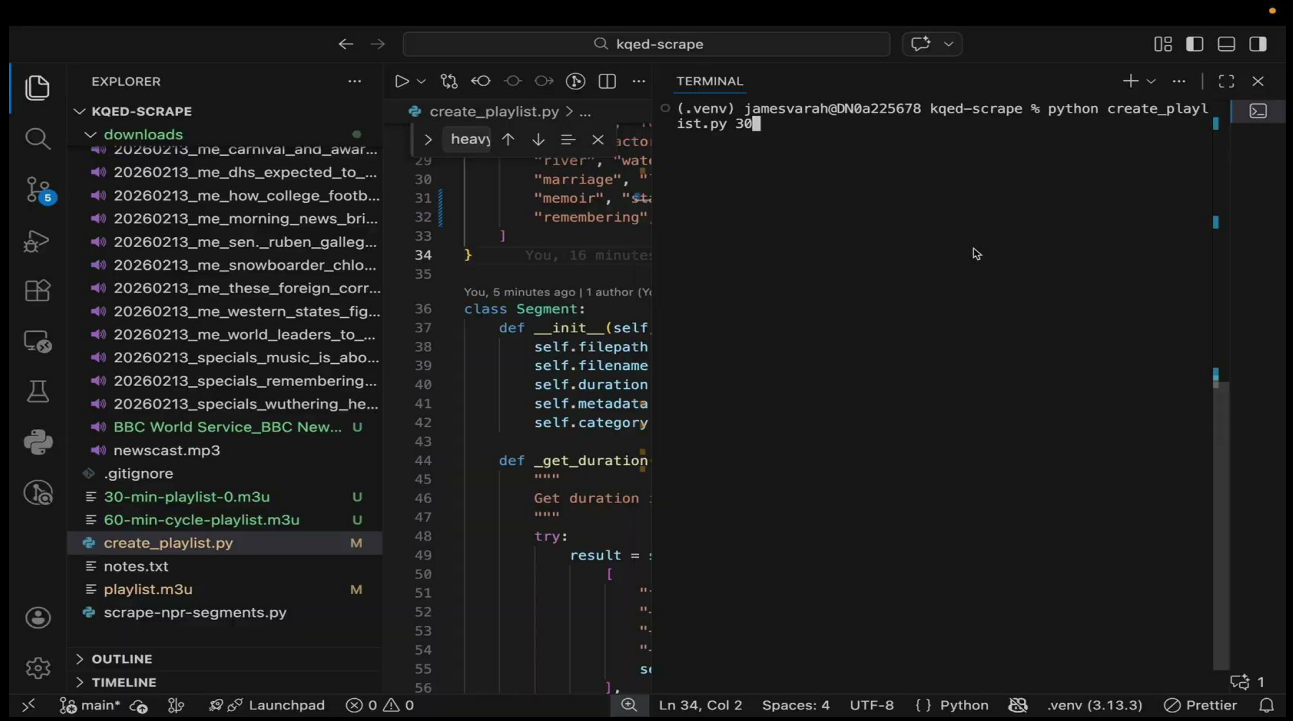
→ fills 90 minutes with no-repeat content

tech world (a.k.a. RadioShack)

on the technical side...

- We are experimenting with effective ways to create a **great** playlist of stories
  - Random selection → Didn't sound good!
  - **Playlist Recipe** (Briefing, heavy story, light story) → Much better!
- To make a playlist, we need to be able to segment **stories** from the audio livestream with **clean start and end points**
  - While NPR does store their segments separately, **KQED does not** store their live segments

playlist creation



Separating editor-defined stories

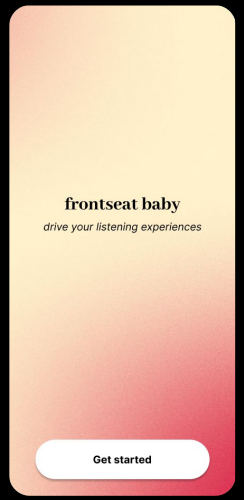
- We initially overlooked this problem: **70% were wrong**
- Now, we realize great user experiences need clean story breaks
- Working on using **radio metadata, speaker detection, and semantic embeddings**
- Consistent problem in media personalization

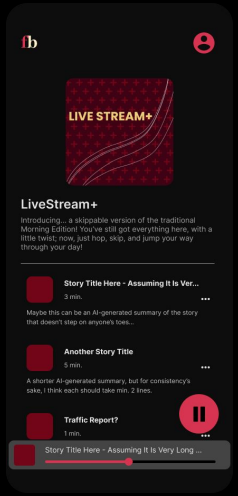
next steps

week 10 goal!

Prepare a Wizard of Oz prototype to answer one simple question:

Do users prefer a skippable, automatically updated playlist built on the current Morning Edition recipe or a playlist personalized by topic that dives deeper into KQED content?





1. Continue to work on segmentation.
2. Pull more clips with, title, date, topic, and show labels to create remixes.
3. Create UI for in-person/remote testing.
4. Interview users.

Thank You!

Questions?